South Africa Wedding & Event Music Pricing Report

Comprehensive Analysis of Bands, DJs, and Live Music Performers

Date: March 2026 | **Sources:** GigHeaven, Gigster, Bridebook, Pink Book, Entertainers Worldwide, The DJ Company, Cream Cheese DJs, DJ Wico, CueUp

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Executive Summary

This report provides a comprehensive analysis of pricing for wedding bands, party bands, DJs, and live music performers across South Africa. Data was collected from **7+ major booking platforms and industry sources**, covering **43 distinct performer categories** with over **1,500 individual listings** from GigHeaven alone, supplemented by cross-referenced data from Gigster, Bridebook, Pink Book, Entertainers Worldwide, CueUp, and individual DJ companies.

Key findings:

- The overall average booking price across all categories is **R17,262**
- **Wedding bands** average **R25,768** (range: R931 to R406,429)
- **Wedding DJs** average **R12,169** (range: R499 to R249,733)
- **Solo performers** average **R10,476** (range: R182 to R157,014)
- Bands cost approximately **2x more** than DJs on average
- Motown, Disco, and Tribute bands command the **highest premiums** (R32,000 to R39,000 average)
- Classical pianists and one-man bands offer the **most affordable** live music options (R7,700 to R8,500 average)

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1. GigHeaven Category Pricing Overview

GigHeaven is South Africa's largest entertainment booking platform. The following table presents pricing across all 43 categories analysed, sorted by average price.

1.1 Complete Category Pricing Table

Category	Group	Listings	Low Price (ZAR)	Average Price (ZAR)	High Price (ZAR)
Motown Bands	Bands	253	R1,862	R39,276	R406,429
Disco Bands	Bands	375	R1,862	R35,053	R406,429
Tribute Bands	Bands	302	R1,862	R32,312	R196,268
Big Bands	Bands	173	R1,862	R32,147	R294,402
Party Bands	Bands	1,071	R976	R29,605	R406,429
Soul Bands	Bands	403	R931	R28,016	R196,268
Pop Bands	Bands	568	R931	R27,743	R406,429
Funk Bands	Bands	413	R931	R27,720	R196,268
Wedding Bands	Bands	1,641	R931	R25,768	R406,429
Cover Bands	Bands	1,004	R931	R25,155	R406,429
Rock Bands	Bands	490	R931	R25,041	R406,429
Swing Bands	Bands	265	R1,862	R20,433	R157,014
A Cappella Groups	Ensembles	84	R1,862	R19,469	R98,122
Jazz Bands	Bands	823	R931	R19,025	R196,268
Reggae / Ska Bands	Bands	269	R931	R18,412	R196,268
Choirs	Ensembles	78	R931	R16,360	R98,122
African Entertainment	Wedding	298	R182	R16,210	R157,014
Blues Bands	Bands	354	R1,862	R15,166	R157,014
Acoustic Bands	Bands	603	R386	R14,984	R157,014
Wedding Musicians	Wedding	1,064	R182	R14,416	R406,429
Wedding Singers	Wedding	706	R499	R13,803	R331,102

Category	Group	Listings	Low Price (ZAR)	Average Price (ZAR)	High Price (ZAR)
Gospel Groups	Ensembles	119	R931	R13,531	R49,061
Classical Ensembles	Ensembles	107	R1,498	R13,259	R53,965
Acoustic Duos	Ensembles	487	R590	R12,827	R78,498
Singers With Backing Tracks	Solo	491	R499	R12,623	R157,014
Wedding DJs	DJs	1,197	R499	R12,169	R249,733
String Quartets	Ensembles	102	R1,498	R12,146	R53,965
Event DJs	DJs	1,153	R499	R11,783	R249,733
Wedding Ceremony Musicians	Wedding	574	R182	R11,669	R157,014
Violinists / Fiddlers	Solo	153	R590	R11,669	R98,122
Singing Pianists	Solo	158	R590	R11,647	R78,498
Classical Guitarists	Solo	109	R590	R11,641	R78,498
Sax & DJ / Live Musician & DJ	DJs	557	R499	R11,572	R98,071
Saxophone Players	Solo	552	R590	R11,533	R98,122
Mobile DJs	DJs	1,003	R499	R10,852	R98,122
Pianists	Solo	226	R590	R10,648	R98,122
Club DJs	DJs	600	R499	R10,625	R98,122
Cellists	Solo	56	R590	R10,574	R53,965
Harpists	Solo	36	R1,498	R10,466	R39,269
Guitarists	Solo	444	R182	R9,899	R98,122
Singing Guitarists	Solo	401	R182	R8,741	R78,498

Category	Group	Listings	Low Price (ZAR)	Average Price (ZAR)	High Price (ZAR)
One Man Bands	Solo	268	R499	R8,559	R78,498
Classical Pianists	Solo	87	R590	R7,715	R53,965

1.2 Average Price by Category (Visual)

Average Price by Category

1.3 Price Range by Category (Visual)

Price Range by Category

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2. Bands Pricing Deep Dive

2.1 Band Categories Ranked by Average Price

Band Type	Avg Price (ZAR)	Low (ZAR)	High (ZAR)	Listings
Motown Bands	R39,276	R1,862	R406,429	253
Disco Bands	R35,053	R1,862	R406,429	375
Tribute Bands	R32,312	R1,862	R196,268	302
Big Bands	R32,147	R1,862	R294,402	173
Party Bands	R29,605	R976	R406,429	1,071
Soul Bands	R28,016	R931	R196,268	403
Pop Bands	R27,743	R931	R406,429	568
Funk Bands	R27,720	R931	R196,268	413
Wedding Bands	R25,768	R931	R406,429	1,641
Cover Bands	R25,155	R931	R406,429	1,004
Rock Bands	R25,041	R931	R406,429	490
Swing Bands	R20,433	R1,862	R157,014	265
Jazz Bands	R19,025	R931	R196,268	823
Reggae / Ska Bands	R18,412	R931	R196,268	269
Blues Bands	R15,166	R1,862	R157,014	354
Acoustic Bands	R14,984	R386	R157,014	603

Key Insight: Specialty and niche bands (Motown, Disco, Tribute) command significantly higher premiums than general wedding or cover bands. The average band booking is approximately **R25,991** across all band types, but ranges dramatically from under R1,000 for budget acts to over R400,000 for premium/celebrity bands.

2.2 Cross-Source Band Pricing (Gigster.co.za)

Gigster.co.za provides industry-standard cost guidelines that complement the GigHeaven marketplace data:

Band Type	Price Range (ZAR)	Duration	Notes
Celebrity / Headliner Bands	R50,000+	1 x 60-90 min set	Upwards, varies significantly
Corporate / Show Bands	R20,000 - R60,000	2-3 x 45 min sets	Professional full bands
Private Function Bands	R8,000 - R30,000	3-4 x 45 min sets	Most common wedding range
Small/Medium African Bands	R6,000 - R12,000	2-3 hours	Cultural entertainment
Larger African Bands	R25,000+	2-3 x 45 min sets	Larger ensembles

2.3 Entertainers Worldwide - Individual Band Quotes

Band Name	Type	Location	Starting Price
ONE ACCORD	Cover Band	Johannesburg	R30,000
Courus	Duo/5-piece	Johannesburg	R20,000
Milkyway Galaxy Band	Afro Jazz	Durban	R20,000
Trio 3	Party Band	Johannesburg	R15,000
CLEMOUR	Party Band	Johannesburg	R12,000
Downtown Gypsies	Duo	Cape Town	R9,000
Heavenly Quartez	Group	Cape Town	R4,000+
MR Pentatonic	Cover Band	KwaZulu-Natal	R3,000
The Salad Peas	Cover Band	Durban	R3,000
Jacques Steyn	Party Band	Cape Town	R2,000+
Phindile The SoulProvider	Jazz Band	Pretoria	R2,000

2.4 Band Pricing Comparison (Visual)

Band Pricing Comparison

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3. DJ Pricing Deep Dive

3.1 GigHeaven DJ Categories

DJ Type	Avg Price (ZAR)	Low (ZAR)	High (ZAR)	Listings
Wedding DJs	R12,169	R499	R249,733	1,197
Event DJs	R11,783	R499	R249,733	1,153
Sax & DJ / Live Musician & DJ	R11,572	R499	R98,071	557
Mobile DJs	R10,852	R499	R98,122	1,003
Club DJs	R10,625	R499	R98,122	600

3.2 DJ Company Package Pricing

The DJ Company (Cape Town) - Event Packages

Package	Regular Price	Promo Price (30% off)	Guests	Includes
Vibe Package	R14,000	R9,799	Up to 40	DJ, sound, basic lighting, mic, valid til 11PM
Celebration Package	R18,000	R12,599	Up to 80	Skilled DJ, mood + dance floor lighting, disco ball, til midnight
Showstopper Package	R25,000	R17,499	Up to 150	Masterful DJ, pro lighting, 2 mics, smoke machine, facade, til midnight

Free extras available (value R800-R1,500 each): UV bars, smoke machine, uplighters, flood lights, motorized disco ball, moving heads.

DJ Wico (Cape Town) - Wedding Packages

Package	Price (ZAR)	Duration	Details
Classic DJ Package	R17,000	~8 hours	Ceremony to reception, up to 80 guests
VIP DJ Package	R20,000	~8 hours	Most popular, enhanced equipment
DJ + Live Musician	R30,500	~8 hours	Includes live band 2 x 45 min sets
DJ + Saxophone	R30,000	~8 hours	Includes sax player 2 x 45 min sets
DJ + Violin	R31,000	~8 hours	Includes violinist 2 x 45 min sets
Dual DJ Package	R38,000	~8 hours	Two DJs for large events

Cream Cheese DJs (Johannesburg)

Metric	Price (ZAR)
Hourly rate (minimum)	R1,200/hour
Hourly rate (recommended)	R1,500/hour
Minimum wedding budget	R8,500+
Typical 5-hour wedding	R6,000 - R7,500

CueUp - Hourly DJ Rates by City

City	Low (per hour)	Average (per hour)	High (per hour)
Johannesburg	~R900 ($50)	~R2,000 ($110)	~R5,400 ($300)
Cape Town	~R1,044 ($58)	~R2,160 ($120)	~R6,300 ($350)
Knysna	~R900 ($50)	~R2,160 ($120)	~R6,300 ($350)
Mossel Bay	~R900 ($50)	~R2,160 ($120)	~R6,300 ($350)

> ***Note:*** *CueUp rates are listed in USD. Conversions use approximate rate of R18/USD.*

Gigster.co.za - DJ Guidelines

DJ Type	Price Range (ZAR)	Notes
Function DJs	R7,000 - R15,000	Standard event DJ
Premium/Specialist DJs	R15,000+	Celebrity or specialist DJs

3.3 DJ Pricing Comparison (Visual)

DJ Pricing Comparison

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4. Solo Performers Pricing

4.1 GigHeaven Solo Performer Categories

Performer Type	Avg Price (ZAR)	Low (ZAR)	High (ZAR)	Listings
Singers With Backing Tracks	R12,623	R499	R157,014	491
Violinists / Fiddlers	R11,669	R590	R98,122	153
Singing Pianists	R11,647	R590	R78,498	158
Classical Guitarists	R11,641	R590	R78,498	109
Saxophone Players	R11,533	R590	R98,122	552
Pianists	R10,648	R590	R98,122	226
Cellists	R10,574	R590	R53,965	56
Harpists	R10,466	R1,498	R39,269	36
Guitarists	R9,899	R182	R98,122	444
Singing Guitarists	R8,741	R182	R78,498	401
One Man Bands	R8,559	R499	R78,498	268
Classical Pianists	R7,715	R590	R53,965	87

4.2 Cross-Source Solo Performer Pricing

Source	Performer Type	Starting Price (ZAR)	Notes
Gigster	Solo Instrumentalists	R3,000+	Upwards
Gigster	Vocalist (backing tracks)	R8,000+	Upwards
Gigster	One-man Band	R6,000 - R15,000	Full range
Bridebook	Solo Musician	R3,000+	Starting from
Bridebook	Ceremony Musician	R2,000 - R6,000	Ceremony only

4.3 Solo Performer Pricing Comparison (Visual)

Solo Performer Pricing

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5. Ensembles & Groups Pricing

5.1 GigHeaven Ensemble Categories

Ensemble Type	Avg Price (ZAR)	Low (ZAR)	High (ZAR)	Listings
A Cappella Groups	R19,469	R1,862	R98,122	84
Choirs	R16,360	R931	R98,122	78
Gospel Groups	R13,531	R931	R49,061	119
Classical Ensembles	R13,259	R1,498	R53,965	107
Acoustic Duos	R12,827	R590	R78,498	487
String Quartets	R12,146	R1,498	R53,965	102

5.2 Cross-Source Ensemble Pricing

Source	Ensemble Type	Price Range (ZAR)
Gigster	Classical Duo	R5,000+
Gigster	Classical Trio	R7,000+
Gigster	Classical Quartet	R9,000+
Gigster	African Choir	R8,000 - R15,000
Bridebook	Duo	R5,000+
Bridebook	String Quartet	R6,000+
Bridebook	Live Band (evening)	R15,000 - R25,000+

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6. Wedding-Specific Categories

6.1 GigHeaven Wedding Categories

Category	Avg Price (ZAR)	Low (ZAR)	High (ZAR)	Listings
African Entertainment	R16,210	R182	R157,014	298
Wedding Musicians	R14,416	R182	R406,429	1,064
Wedding Singers	R13,803	R499	R331,102	706
Wedding Ceremony Musicians	R11,669	R182	R157,014	574

6.2 Overall Wedding Music Budget (Industry Sources)

Source	Category	Budget Range (ZAR)	Notes
Bridebook (2025)	Overall wedding music	R6,000 - R25,000	DJ, solo, or full band
Bridebook (2025)	Wedding DJ	R4,000 - R10,000	Depends on equipment & time
Bridebook (2025)	Wedding DJ (avg)	R8,000 - R15,000	Average spend
Bridebook (2025)	Live Band (evening)	R15,000 - R25,000+	Depending on size & reputation
Pink Book	Wedding DJ	R8,500	3.5% of R250k budget
Pink Book	Budget allocation	3.5% of total budget	Recommended percentage

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7. Other Entertainment Pricing (Non-Music)

Based on Bridebook South Africa data:

Entertainment Type	Starting Price (ZAR)	Typical Range	Notes
Fireworks	R12,000	R12,000+	Duration & customisation dependent
Casino Entertainment	R10,000	R10,000+	Blackjack, roulette, poker tables
Circus Performers	R8,000	R8,000+	Fire jugglers, stilt walkers, aerial
Dancers	R8,000	R8,000+	Traditional African to modern
Magician	R5,000	R5,000+	Roaming/close-up
Mind Reader	R5,000	R5,000 - R20,000+	Up to international performers
Children's Entertainment	R3,000	R3,000+	Play corners, activity packs
Face/Glitter Artists	R3,000	R3,000+	All ages
Photo Booth (2hr)	R2,300	R2,300 - R5,000+	Standard to premium/360
Bouncy Castle	R2,000	R2,000+	Outdoor weddings

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8. Group Comparison Summary

8.1 Average Pricing by Performer Group

Group	Categories	Avg Low Price	Mean Avg Price	Avg High Price
Bands (16 types)	16	R1,253	R25,991	R261,967
Ensembles & Groups	6	R1,226	R14,599	R68,972
Wedding-Specific	4	R516	R14,024	R223,926
DJs (5 types)	5	R499	R11,400	R162,684
Solo Performers	12	R1,208	R10,476	R80,016

8.2 Group Comparison (Visual)

Group Comparison

8.3 Price Distribution (Visual)

Price Distribution

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9. Budget Planning Guide

Based on all sources analysed, here is a practical budget guide for wedding and event music in South Africa:

9.1 Budget Tiers

Budget Tier	Total Music Budget	What You Can Expect
Economy	R3,000 - R8,000	Solo performer (guitarist, pianist) OR basic DJ for a few hours
Mid-Range	R8,000 - R15,000	Professional DJ for full day OR acoustic duo/trio OR ceremony musician + basic DJ
Standard	R15,000 - R25,000	Premium DJ package with lighting OR small live band (3-4 piece) OR DJ + live musician combo
Premium	R25,000 - R40,000	Full wedding band (5+ piece) OR premium DJ + saxophone/violin OR DJ + live band sets
Luxury	R40,000 - R60,000	Corporate-quality show band OR dual DJ setup OR band + DJ combination package
Ultra-Premium	R60,000+	Celebrity/headliner acts, large ensembles, or multi-act entertainment packages

9.2 Cost Factors

The following factors significantly influence pricing:

1. **Number of performers** - Each additional musician adds R3,000-R8,000+
2. **Duration** - Most quotes are for 2-4 hours; overtime rates apply (typically R1,000-R2,500/hour)
3. **Travel distance** - Most packages include 20-60km; beyond that, expect R5-R10 per km
4. **Equipment** - Premium sound and lighting can add R2,000-R10,000
5. **Day of week** - Saturday weddings command premium rates; weekday events may be 10-20% cheaper
6. **Season** - Peak season (October-March) rates are higher than off-peak
7. **Experience/reputation** - Established acts with strong reviews charge 50-100% more than newcomers

8. **Location** - Cape Town and Johannesburg tend to be 10-20% more expensive than other regions

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10. Data Sources & Methodology

Source	Data Type	Coverage
GigHeaven.com	43 categories, 1,500+ listings	Marketplace prices (low/avg/high per category)
Gigster.co.za	Cost guidelines by performer type	Industry-standard rate ranges
Bridebook.com	2025 wedding music cost guide	Average spend ranges for SA couples
Pink Book	Wedding budget breakdown	Percentage-based budgeting
Entertainers Worldwide	Individual performer quotes	16+ individual listings with prices
The DJ Company	3 tiered event packages	Cape Town-based DJ packages
DJ Wico	6 wedding packages	Cape Town premium DJ packages
Cream Cheese DJs	Hourly rates	Johannesburg-based DJ rates
CueUp	Hourly DJ rates by city	International platform with SA DJs

> ***Disclaimer:*** *All prices are in South African Rand (ZAR) unless otherwise noted. Prices are indicative and subject to change. Actual quotes may vary based on specific requirements, availability, and negotiation. Data was collected in March 2026 and reflects the most current publicly available information.*

Report generated from analysis of 43 categories, 1,500+ individual listings, and 7+ industry sources.